C1 Listening

A radio discussion: who thinks what

Track several speakers in a discussion and match each opinion, agreement or objection to the right person.

Discussions are harder than monologues: speakers interrupt, agree partly, and change their position. C1 tasks often ask *who* holds a view, so keep a note for each speaker rather than one general summary.

Function	Signals
Strong agreement	*Absolutely. I couldn't agree more. That's exactly the point.*
Partial agreement	*Up to a point. I see what you mean, but... That's true as far as it goes.*
Disagreement	*I'm not sure that's right. I'd take issue with that. With respect,...*
Changing position	*Actually, you've made me reconsider. I'd go along with that.*
Bringing someone in	*What's your take on this, Sami? Where do you stand?*

Listen

▼ **Show transcript**

Host: Today's question: should universities drop entrance exams? Nadia, you're a head teacher. Nadia: I'd scrap them tomorrow. A single exam rewards students who can afford private tutors, not necessarily the most able. Host: Sami, you lecture in engineering. Sami: I see what Nadia means, but I'd take issue with scrapping them altogether. School grades vary enormously between schools, so we need some common measure. Host: Huda, you're a student. Where do you stand? Huda: Honestly, I agree with Sami up to a point. The exam was stressful, but it was the only time I felt everyone was judged on the same terms. What I'd change is the format: fewer multiple-choice questions and more problem solving. Nadia: Actually, that's a fair point. If the exam tested reasoning rather than memory, I could go along with keeping it.

Make a speaker grid. Write each name with two columns: *view* and *reason*. Add an arrow if someone changes their mind.

Common mistake. Recording a speaker's first opinion as their final one. Listen to the end: here one speaker moves towards a compromise.

Practice

1. What is Nadia's first opinion, and her reason?
2. Why does Sami want to keep some form of exam?
3. Does Huda agree completely with Sami? Which phrase tells you?
4. What change does Huda suggest?
5. How does Nadia's position change at the end?

▼ **Show answers**

1. Scrap the exams, because they favour students who can pay for tutors.
2. School grades vary a lot, so a common measure is needed.
3. No, only partly: "up to a point".
4. Fewer multiple-choice questions and more problem solving.
5. She could accept keeping the exam if it tested reasoning rather than memory.